



Masters of the Game

**Fourteen
Bangalore boys
give the world a
Made in India
game**

Yashraj Vakhil and Ahmed Shaikh

The two-storey house veils a covert operation. It is an innocuous façade to a clandestine project. You are expected to walk past, turning a blind eye to the acts of maximum chaos within. It seems to be designed thus. Let curiosity guide you inside however; try not to stare at the typical family that resides within. Do notice the glint in the son's eyes—he is hiding something! Take a flight of stairs to the portal that shields the secret...

Opening the door is akin to lifting an innocent rock in a sedate garden, only to find a hub of activity underneath.

We see Vikram and Keshav sniping at each other, arguing whether to approve the design of a particular game level. Snap! Snap! Argue, argue!

Ashray, the Design Lead has been up all night, tending to his polygonal gardens. Orthogonal surfaces, in numerous shapes and sizes, stare him in the face—they are trees, virtually speaking; always in need of pruning to fit the polygonal budget of a level...

A familiar scent hangs in the air. Smells like teen spirit. Nay, deadlines. The Lab is buzzing

with activity. Sheets are everywhere, with artists furtive in their need to pencil thoughts down. Scratch! Scratch! Erase, erase!

Posters, concept sketches, and level maps paint the walls; a small bulletin board hangs like a sword with razor-sharp deadlines.

Deadlines!

The hushed-word screams the loudest. Even the phones and PDAs hum missed calls, and beep to-dos gone past. Only Daisy seems unaffected. The beloved German Shepherd prances around in all her innocent glory. Quick! Somebody teach her how to code!

Welcome to Raptor Entertainment: an up and coming game development outfit in Bangalore—some say the best India has to offer the video-game industry.

Children Of A Dream

Sandeep Kowdley and Jayanth K set up Raptor Entertainment in December 2001, a time when the video-gaming scene in India was nascent enough to be classified as non-existent. The challenge was to develop a game engine to power digital dreams. A unique challenge seen from any angle: if gaming was embryonic, game development in India was fantasy. "The greatest challenge has been getting a grip on the philosophies